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- **Choice and availability:** One of the best features of the open source software model is that it offers you a wide choice and you will always find an open source solution to suit your requirements.
- **Highly customisable:** You can customise the open source software as per your needs and can build your own framework using it.
- **Lowers costs:** OSS reduces the overall cost of evaluation and implementation.
- **A viable business model:** Open source software has demonstrated a high level of reliability and robustness, and can prove to be a viable business model that can lead to robust revenue streams. Naaptol is a great example.
- **Support options/forums:** A wide range of details are

available from the community via forums, which can help you perform the right implementation.

- **Easy migration of resources:** Since knowledge of OSS is openly available, you can easily migrate, training existing human resources to a good level, in a minimal time.
- **Greater scalability:** The open source IT architecture boosts a company's scalability without any bottlenecks.

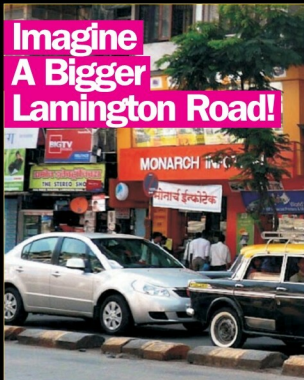
Future challenges

So, what are the major challenges down the road? "The e-commerce industry is witnessing a boom in the Indian market since the last few years. So, if we wish to cope with the competition and widen our footprint in the industry, there is a need for a day-to-day adoption of open source technology to customise data analysis tools and automation in different areas with engagement of large scale data handling at a higher speed. This is one major challenge going forward and we will soon come out with the means to combat this issue. Moreover, we often seek the help of the open source community through blogs and forums to find solutions to our problems."

Open source technology has surely propelled Naaptol onto the fast track and we are sure many other firms will plunge into the FOSS world in the years to come! **END** 

By Priyanka Sarkar

The author is a member of the editorial team. She loves to weave in and out the little nuances of life and scribble her thoughts and experiences in her personal blog.



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